

The Song of Salt

A conflicted granddaughter, sent to remove her blind boatman grandfather from his beloved sea, instead discovers the untold story of his life's profound connection to it, healing old family wounds and finding her own sense of belonging by embracing his 'Lunara Gita' - the enduring song of the ocean.

1. INT. Ananya's Luxury Apartment – DAY

Characters: Ananya

ANANYA, mid-twenties, places a lavender macaron by a ceramic coffee cup on her luxury apartment's white marble counter. Sunlight floods the room, illuminating dust motes in the silent air.

She adjusts a glossy fashion magazine, then steps back, phone raised. Her lips curve into a practiced grin as she snaps multiple photos of the staged scene.

Her thumb scrolls. The grin vanishes. Her shoulders drop slightly as the phone lowers, leaving the macaron untouched, a vibrant speck in the quiet room.

2. INT. Ananya's Luxury Apartment – DAY

Characters: Ananya

Ananya's phone buzzes on the marble counter. She sees "Ma" on the screen, a flicker of annoyance crossing her face before she answers.

Bina (O.S.)

ହ୍ୟାଲୋ, ଅନନ୍ୟା! ବାପାଙ୍କ ସହ କଥା ହେଲୁଣି ତ?

Ananya

ହଁ, ମା! କଲି। ସେ ଏବେ ଠିକ୍ ଅଛନ୍ତି।

Bina (O.S.)

ଠିକ୍ ଅଛନ୍ତି? କେବେ ଆଶୁଛୁ ତାଙ୍କୁ? କେତେ ଦିନ ଆଉ ଅପେକ୍ଷା କରିବୁ? ସେ ସମୁଦ୍ର କୂଳରେ କାହିଁକି ରହିବେ?

Ananya pinches the bridge of her nose, her jaw tight.

Ananya

ମା, ସେ ଆସିବାକୁ ଚାହୁଁନାହାନ୍ତି। ସେ କହୁଛନ୍ତି...

Bina (O.S.)

କ'ଣ କହୁଛନ୍ତି? ସବୁବେଳେ ସେଇ ସମୁଦ୍ର କଥା? ସେଠାରେ ତାଙ୍କର କ'ଣ ଅଛି ଯେ ଛାଡ଼ି ପାରୁନାହାନ୍ତି? ତାଙ୍କୁ ଯେମିତି ହେଉ ବୁଝାଇ ନେଇ ଆସ। ମୁଁ ଆଉ ବେଶୀ ଦିନ ଅପେକ୍ଷା କରିପାରିବିନି।

Ananya stares at the untouched macaron, her expression hardening. No immediate reply.

3. EXT. Fishing Village Shoreline – DAY

Characters: ANANYA, DUKHI, VILLAGER 1, VILLAGER 2

Ananya walks gingerly, her expensive sandals crunching on the shells embedded in the damp sand. Her gaze sweeps over the cluster of rough-hewn boats and thatched huts, her mouth a thin line of discomfort.

Nearby, two fishermen, VILLAGER 1 and VILLAGER 2, stand over a tangled heap of fishing net. Villager 1's voice is a sharp bark, his hand chopping the air towards Villager 2, who gestures defensively.

Dukhi appears from behind a stack of drying nets. He moves slowly, one hand gliding along a weather-beaten wooden staff. His face, etched with age, turns towards the rising voices.

DUKHI

ଫିଲାମାନେ, କାହିଁକି ଏତେ ପାଟିତୁଣ୍ଡ?

The fishermen's argument falters as Dukhi's presence registers. Their hands drop to their sides, and their postures soften.

VILLAGER 1

ଦୁଖୀବାପା! ଏ ମୋ ଜାଲରୁ ମାଛ ଚୋରି କରୁଥିଲା

Dukhi's hand rises, a calm, steady motion. Villager 1's shoulders slump.

DUKHI

ସମୁଦ୍ର ମା' କାହାରି ଜିନିଷ ଚୋରି କରେନା ତା'ର ଗୀତ ଶୁଣ

The two men look at each other, then down at their feet. Their faces lose the tension, replaced by a quiet respect. Ananya lowers her smartphone, which she had been holding at her side. Her tight expression eases into one of quiet observation.

4. INT. Dukhi's Hut – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi

Ananya perches on a rough wooden bench, her eyes sweeping the humble hut. She notes bundled fishing nets hanging from the rafters and worn carvings on the walls. Dukhi reclines on a reed mat on the floor, his blind gaze directed towards the open doorway. A light breeze shifts a faded cotton curtain at the entrance.

Ananya

ଜେଜେ, ତମେ କାହିଁକି ବୁଝୁନ? ଏଠି ରହିବାର ଆଉ କିଛି ମାନେ ନାହିଁ।

Dukhi

ମା' ଅନନ୍ୟା, ମୁଁ ଏ ମାଟି ଛାଡ଼ି କୁଆଡ଼େ ଯିବି? ମୋ ଜୀବନ ତ ଏଇଠି।

Ananya

ସହରରେ ତମର ସବୁ ସୁବିଧା ହେବା ଆଉ ତମେ ଆରାମରେ ରହିପାରିବ।

A gentle crinkle forms around Dukhi's eyes, softening the lines of his aged face.

Dukhi

ସୁବିଧା? ସୁଖ କଣ ସେଇଠି ମିଳିବ? ମୋ ସମୁଦ୍ରର ଗୀତ କଣ ସହରରେ ଶୁଣାଯିବ? 'ଲୁଣାର ଗୀତ' ପାଇଁ କାନ ଖୋଲା ଥିଲେ, ଏଇଠି ହିଁ ରହିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ।

Ananya's shoulders slump slightly. She touches the rough, splintered surface of the wooden bench, then recoils her hand subtly.

Ananya

କିନ୍ତୁ ଜେଜେ...

Dukhi

କିନ୍ତୁ ନାହିଁ ମା'। ମୁଁ ଏଇଠି ଅଛି।

5. INT. Dukhi's Hut – NIGHT

Characters: Ananya

Ananya sits hunched on the worn mat inside Dukhi's dimly lit hut. The only light in the room pulses from her phone screen, casting a stark, almost accusatory glow across her features. Her fingers fly across the keypad, a determined, almost angry energy in her movements. She scrolls through a gallery of images and short video clips she's captured: the vibrant fishing boats, children playing near the shore, but also worn-out nets, modest huts, and the sprawling, untouched coastline. She selects several, then types a caption with swift, precise jabs of her thumbs. The text on her screen speaks of "raw, untapped beauty" and "unrealized potential," hinting at the area's lack of modern infrastructure and development. She hits POST, the screen briefly flashing a confirmation.

6. INT. Corporate Office, Bhubaneswar – DAY

Characters: SANJAY

The glass wall of SANJAY's office overlooks the sprawling urban landscape of Bhubaneswar. He sits at an immaculately clean desk, a large, thin tablet resting on its surface.

His thumb scrolls methodically. He pauses on a vibrant series of photos showing rustic fishing huts, brightly colored boats, and untouched stretches of coastline. He reads the accompanying text with an almost surgical focus.

His eyes, initially dispassionate, widen fractionally as he taps the screen. A digital map expands, revealing a remote coastal village. He zooms in, isolating the cluster of homes near the water.

His index finger descends, pressing firmly against the glass, marking the exact location on the digital map. He leans back, a slow, predatory calculation hardening his gaze.

SANJAY

ଏଇଟା ତ ପଞ୍ଜା ତିଲ୍ ପାଇଁ ତିଆରି ହୋଇଛି।

7. EXT. Village Shoreline – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi, DEVELOPER, VILLAGER

Two black SUVs kick up dust, braking hard on the shoreline. Three men in suits, clipboards in hand, step out.

One man immediately starts hammering bright orange stakes into the sand, marching towards the fishing boats.

DEVELOPER

ଏ ଜାଗା ଏବେ ଆମର! ସବୁ ଖାଲି କର!

An old VILLAGER steps forward, hands pleading. The developer shoves him aside. The stakes surround Dukhi's boat.

VILLAGER

କିନ୍ତୁ ଆମେ ପୁରୁଷ ପୁରୁଷ ଧରି ଏଇଠି ରହୁଛୁ!

Dukhi emerges from his hut, his blind eyes turning towards the noise. A deep furrow appears on his brow. Ananya, frozen, witnesses the escalating aggression.

8. EXT. Village Shoreline – DAY

Characters: ANANYA, DEVELOPER, OLD VILLAGER, DUKHI

The DEVELOPER shoves the OLD VILLAGER again, harder this time. The old man loses his balance, falling to his knees in the soft sand, coughing into his hand.

DEVELOPER

ଯାଆ ଏଠୁ ବୁଢ଼ା! ଏ ଜାଗା ଏବେ ଆମ କମ୍ପାନୀର! ବାହାର!

Ananya watches the old man struggle to regain his footing, his face creased with fear. Her gaze snaps to Dukhi, who stands rigid, his face grim, his walking stick gripped tightly. Ananya's jaw tightens. Her shoulders square. She strides forward, placing herself squarely between the Developer and the fallen villager, her shadow falling over him.

ANANYA

କିଏ ତୁମେମାନେ? ବୁଢ଼ା ଲୋକକୁ କାହିଁକି ଠେଲୁଛ? ଏଠି ଦାଦାଗିରି କରିବାକୁ ଆସିଛ?

The DEVELOPER freezes, his hammer mid-air. He slowly lowers it, turning his full attention to Ananya. He eyes her from head to toe, a dismissive smirk stretching his lips.

DEVELOPER

ଆରେ ଝିଅ, ତୁମେ ପୁଣି କିଏ? ଏସବୁ ତୁମ କାମ ନୁହେଁ! ଯାଆ ଏଠୁ!

ANANYA

ମୁଁ କିଏ, ସେଥିରେ ତୁମର କ'ଣ ଯାଏ ଆସେ? ଏମାନଙ୍କୁ ହଇରାଣ କରୁଛ କାହିଁକି? ଏ ଜାଗା ସେମାନଙ୍କର, ତୁମର ନୁହେଁ!

9. INT. Masi's Hut – NIGHT

Characters: ANANYA, MASI

A small oil lamp flickers on a low wooden shelf, casting wavering light on the mud walls of Masi's hut. Ananya sits cross-legged on a woven mat, her expression drawn.

Masi meticulously buffs a cowrie shell with a small, damp cloth, her fingers tracing its ridges. She doesn't look at Ananya.

MASI

ତୋ ମା' ଏଠି ରହିପାରିବନି, ଲୋ ମା'।

Masi pauses, holding the polished shell up to the lamp, inspecting its gleam. Her gaze then drifts to Ananya, soft and knowing.

MASI

ସମୁଦ୍ରକୁ ତା'ର ଭାରି ଡର।

ANANYA

ମୁଁ ଜାଣେ କିନ୍ତୁ କାହିଁକି ଏତେ ଡର? ଛୋଟବେଳୁ ସେ ସବୁବେଳେ
କୁହନ୍ତି, ସମୁଦ୍ର ସବୁ ଖାଇଦିଏ।

Masi gently places the cowrie with a small pile of other polished shells. She turns her body fully towards Ananya, her eyes distant, reliving an old memory before her focus sharpens. Her voice drops to a near whisper.

MASI

ବହୁତ ବର୍ଷ ତଳେ... ତୁ ଜନ୍ମ ହେବା ପୂର୍ବରୁ... ତୋ ବାପାଙ୍କର ଜଣେ
ବଡ଼ ଭାଇ ଥିଲ। ସେ ତାଙ୍କର ଅତି ପ୍ରିୟ ଥିଲେ।

ANANYA

ମୋ ବଡ଼ବାପା?

MASI

ହଁ ସେ ବେଳେ ବେଳେ ଏଠିକି ଆସନ୍ତି... ଦିନେ ଭୀଷଣ ବାତ୍ୟା
ହେଲା। ସବୁ ଉଜାଡ଼ିଦେଲା।

Masi's eyes fix on the small, open window, where the low rumble of the distant sea is just audible.

MASI

ତାଙ୍କୁ କେହି ଖୋଜି ପାଇଲେନି।

Ananya freezes, her gaze locked on Masi. The hand resting on her knee slowly clenches into a tight fist.

ANANYA

ସମୁଦ୍ର... ତାଙ୍କୁ ନେଇଗଲା?

Masi gives one slow, solemn nod. The lamplight catches a glint of moisture in her eyes.

MASI

ସେଇଦିନଠୁ ତୋ ମା' ଭାଙ୍ଗି ପଡ଼ିଲା। ସମୁଦ୍ର ତା' ପାଇଁ କେବଳ
ଭୟ... ଆଉ ହରାଇବାର ଦୁଃଖ। ସେଥିପାଇଁ ସେ ଏ ଜାଗା ଛାଡ଼ି
ପଳେଇଲା।

Ananya slowly turns her head, looking past the open doorway of the
hut, towards the constant, deep hum of the ocean in the quiet night.

10. EXT. Village Well and Fishing Grounds – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Villager, Woman, Children

Ananya walks towards the familiar fishing grounds. Her steps falter as she spots a crude, barbed-wire FENCE stretching across the sandy path, blocking access to the sea. Her eyes widen in disbelief.

A VILLAGER stands before it, his fist banging hard against a fence post. His face is tight with frustration.

VILLAGER

ଆମ ଜାଗାକୁ ବାଡ଼ ପକାଇ ଦେଲେ! ମାଛ ଧରିବାକୁ ଯିବୁ କେମିତି?

Ananya's jaw tightens. She stares at the sharp wires, a flicker of cold anger in her gaze. A distressed CRY from nearby pulls her attention away. She spins around and rushes towards the village well.

A WOMAN struggles with the hand pump, its metal handle bent and broken. Children huddle nearby, whimpering softly, clutching empty pots.

WOMAN

ପାଣି ନାହିଁ! ସବୁ ଶୁଖିଲା ପଡ଼ିଛି। ଏତେ ନିର୍ଦ୍ଦୟ କେମିତି
ହୋଇପାରିବେ ଏମାନେ?

Ananya looks from the broken pump to the terrified children, then back towards the fenced-off shore. Her knuckles whiten as her hands clench into fists at her sides. A fierce resolve hardens her features, replacing her earlier annoyance.

ANANYA

ଏମାନେ ଏତେ ତଳକୁ ଖସିପାରନ୍ତି?

11. EXT. Sacred Fishing Spot – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi, Developer

Ananya and Dukhi approach a small, secluded cove. The familiar cluster of smooth, sea-worn stones, where Dukhi always offered his prayers, is now scattered across the sand. A rough, wooden signpost lies splintered.

Two DEVELOPERS finish hammering a printed NOTICE onto a newly erected, crude wooden stake. They glance at Dukhi and Ananya, a smirk playing on their lips, then turn and walk away, their footsteps crunching on seashells.

Dukhi's hand trembles as he reaches out towards the scattered stones. His head droops, his shoulders slumping forward.

DUKHI

ଏ କ'ଣ କରିଦେଲେ ସେମାନେ? ଏଇ ଜାଗା... ମୋ ବାପା ଅଜାଙ୍କ
ସ୍ମୃତି... ସବୁ ନଷ୍ଟ କରିଦେଲେ।

Ananya's gaze falls upon the harsh, official print on the eviction notice. Her shoulders slump forward. Her breath catches, a visible tightness in her jaw. She stares, unblinking, at the document.

ANANYA

ମୁଁ ଏ କ'ଣ କରିଦେଲି?

She crushes the notice in her hand, the paper crumpling loudly.

ANANYA

ସବୁ ଶେଷ ହୋଇଗଲା ବୋଲି ଲାଗୁଛି।

12. EXT. Desecrated Spot – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi

Ananya watches Dukhi. The crumpled eviction notice still held tight in her hand. Dukhi slowly raises his head, his sightless eyes appearing to trace the scattered debris of the desecrated spot. He bends, his old knees cracking faintly as he lowers himself to the ground.

He fumbles at his waist, untying a small, worn cloth pouch. From within, he carefully pulls out a perfectly spiral-patterned seashell, smooth and polished by the sea. He holds it gently in his open palm, his thumb slowly stroking its ridges.

He places the seashell onto a flat stone, the only one remaining unbroken amidst the splintered wood and scattered rocks. He bows his head slightly, a private moment.

DUKHI

ଏଇଠି ହିଁ ରହିବୁ। ଯେତେଦିନ ଆମେ ଅଛୁ, ତୁ ବି ଥିବୁ।

Ananya's eyes are fixed on the small, vibrant shell. The ocean waves crash softly in the background, a constant, rhythmic sound. Her shoulders, previously slumped, slowly begin to rise, pulling back with a deliberate effort.

Her jaw muscles clench, a small knot forming at the corner of her mouth. Her hands, still holding the crushed notice, curl into tight fists at her sides. She inhales deeply, her chest visibly expanding.

Her chin rises. Her gaze hardens, sweeping from the shell, past Dukhi, and out towards the distant horizon. She turns abruptly, taking a firm, deliberate step onto the path out of the cove.

13. INT. Ananya's Temporary Village Workspace – NIGHT

Characters: ANANYA

A battery-operated lantern casts a warm, flickering glow, illuminating a rough, upturned wooden crate. This improvised workstation supports ANANYA's open laptop. A spiral-bound notebook, filled with quick Odia script and sketches, lies beside it, pushed among empty tea cups and tangled charging cables. The soft hum of the laptop fan fills the quiet hut as her fingers fly across the keyboard, eyes glued to the screen.

The laptop screen shows a video editing timeline. She drags and drops digital clips: a jarring segment of developers' bulldozers scarring the shore, a quick zoom on the crumpled eviction notice, and a poignant, slow-motion shot of Dukhi's hand gently placing the seashell on the sand. She adjusts a small, clip-on microphone attached to her collar, then speaks, her voice clear and resonant, over the recorded visuals.

ANANYA (O.S.)

ଏଇ ମାଟି, ଏଇ ପାଣି ଆମ ବାପ ଅଜା ଅମଳରୁ ଆମରା ଏଇଟା
କେବଳ ମାଛ ମାରିବାର ଜାଗା ନୁହେଁ, ଏଇଟା ଆମ ଜୀବନ।
ସେମାନେ ଆମ ଲୁଣାର ଗୀତ ବିଷୟରେ କ'ଣ ବୁଝିବେ?

She taps the spacebar. The short, impactful sequence plays back. A quiet, determined focus holds her gaze as the render progress bar swiftly fills, the laptop's hum a steady companion.

14. EXT. Various Locations (Bhubaneswar/Online) – DAY

Characters: Ananya, NEWS ANCHOR

A HAND-HELD PHONE screen glows. Ananya's post, a collage of the desecrated shoreline and Dukhi's quiet protest, displays hundreds of likes, shares, and a stream of supportive comments in Odia. A finger scrolls down, revealing more engagement.

A LAPTOP screen in a sparsely decorated room shows a news aggregator. A headline flashes: "Village Victim of Corporate Greed: Campaign to Save Coastal Area". Below it, a thumbnail of Ananya's video plays on a loop, showing the developers' bulldozer.

On a TELEVISION in a busy tea stall, a NEWS ANCHOR speaks with urgency, graphics of the fishing village overlaid on the screen.

NEWS ANCHOR

ଏହି ଗ୍ରାମବାସୀମାନେ ସେମାନଙ୍କ ପୂର୍ବପୁରୁଷର ଭୂମି ଏବଂ ସମୁଦ୍ରକୁ
ବଞ୍ଚାଇବା ପାଇଁ ଏକତ୍ରିତ ହୋଇଛନ୍ତି। ସୋସିଆଲ ମିଡିଆରେ
ଭାଇରାଲ ହେଉଛି ଏହି ଅଭିଯାନ।

15. EXT. Village Square – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi, Masi, Villager 1

A large gathering of villagers stands close in the open village square, forming a semicircle. Ananya perches on an overturned, weathered fishing boat, using it as a temporary platform. Dukhi and Masi are visible among the attentive faces in the crowd. Ananya gestures with firm, deliberate movements as she outlines her strategy.

ANANYA

ଆମେ ଆମର ଗାଁକୁ, ଆମ ସମୁଦ୍ରକୁ ବଞ୍ଚାଇବା। ଆମେ ଶାନ୍ତିରେ
ପ୍ରତିବାଦ କରିବା। କେହି ହିଂସା କରିବେ ନାହିଁ।

ANANYA

ଆମର ବାଉଁଶ ସ୍ତମ୍ଭ ହେବା ଦରକାର। ଏ ଜମି, ଏ ସମୁଦ୍ର ଆମର।
ଏହା ଆମ ପୂର୍ବପୁରୁଷଙ୍କ ଠାରୁ ମିଳିଛି।

Villagers murmur their agreement, their expressions shifting from frustration to a shared sense of resolve.

VILLAGER 1

ଆମେ ପ୍ରସ୍ତୁତ, ମା' ଆମେ ସବୁ କରିବା।

MASI

ଆମ ଲୁଣାର ଗୀତକୁ କେହି ରୁପ କରିପାରିବେ ନାହିଁ!

ANANYA

ଠିକ୍ କହିଛ ମାଉସୀ। ଏହା ହିଁ ଆମର ଶକ୍ତି।

Dukhi tilts his head, a gentle, knowing expression settling on his features as he listens.

16. EXT. Village Square – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Bina, Dukhi, Masi, Villagers

Ananya stands on the overturned boat, her voice clear, carrying across the village square. Villagers listen, some nodding, others exchanging determined glances.

Ananya

ଏ ମାଟି, ଏ ପାଣି ଆମର ପରିଚୟ। ଆମର ସାହସକୁ କେହି
ଭାଙ୍ଗିପାରିବେ ନାହିଁ।

A dusty yellow taxi, starkly out of place, stops at the edge of the square. Bina steps out, dressed in crisp city clothes, her posture rigid. She eyes the crowd, then spots Ananya on the boat. She sees Dukhi and Masi among the attentive faces.

Ananya

ଆମର ଲୁଣାର ଗୀତ କେବେବି ବନ୍ଦ ହେବନାହିଁ ଏହା ଆମ
ପୂର୍ବପୁରୁଷଙ୍କ ଶକ୍ତି।

A deep crease forms between Bina's brows. Her gaze softens, yet holds a new intensity. She watches Ananya's unwavering conviction, the way the community rallies around her. Bina's rigid shoulders slowly relax.

17. INT. Village Meeting Hall – NIGHT

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi, Bina, Lead Developer, Villagers

The air in the village meeting hall is thick with tension. VILLAGERS huddle on the floor, their faces etched with worry. A LEAD DEVELOPER, flanked by two others, stands by a long table, holding up a stack of legal documents. Dukhi sits quietly, his sightless eyes fixed forward. Bina stands near the back, her gaze fixed on Ananya.

LEAD DEVELOPER

ଏ ଆଇନଗତ ନୋଟିସ୍ ଆପଣମାନଙ୍କୁ ଆଉ ୨୪ ଘଣ୍ଟା ମିଳିବ।
ତା'ପରେ ଏ ଜାଗା ଆମର।

A collective gasp ripples through the villagers. Some mothers pull their children closer. Ananya walks forward, taking the document from the developer. She scans the legalese quickly, her jaw tightening. Her eyes meet Dukhi's, then sweep across the frightened faces of her community. She holds the document in a firm grip, then slowly tears it in half.

ANANYA

୨୪ ଘଣ୍ଟା? ହିସାବରେ ଗୋଟେ ମିନିଟ୍ ବି ନୁହେଁ।

She lets the pieces flutter to the ground. Dukhi offers a small, knowing smile.

ANANYA

ଏ ମାଟି ଆମର। ଏଇଠି ଆମେ ରହିବୁ।

18. EXT. Village Shoreline / Protest Site – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Bina, Dukhi, Masi, Lead Developer, Legal Counsel, Villagers, Reporters, Cameramen

The shoreline pulses with hundreds of villagers, a solid wall of people standing firm behind a thin rope stretched taut along the sand. This rope marks the developers' demarcation line. Hand-painted banners, weathered by sun and salt, flap rhythmically in the strong sea breeze, proclaiming " , " (Our land, our life) and " " (Our rights are ours). REPORTERS and CAMERAMEN from various news outlets jostle for position, their lenses and microphones glinting under the mid-morning sun, capturing every angle of the organized resistance. Ananya moves through the dense crowd, a confident nod for one villager, a quick, reassuring glance for another, her presence a quiet strength. Bina stands near Masi, her arm linked through her mother's, her gaze fixed on Ananya, a slight tremor in her posture revealing a hidden anxiety. Dukhi sits cross-legged on the sand, his hands resting open, palms down, at his sides. His face, weathered by years of sun and sea, is serene, tilted slightly towards the incoming tide, absorbing its rhythm.

The LEAD DEVELOPER, a sharply dressed man in a sweat-stained suit, pushes through the cluster of reporters with his two harried associates. Their expensive clothes look out of place against the sandy backdrop. They exude an air of utter defeat, their steps heavy.

An older, distinguished LEGAL COUNSEL, representing the villagers, steps forward, holding up a thick, well-worn file.

LEGAL COUNSEL

ମିଷ୍ଟର ଦାସ, ଆମ ପାଖରେ ସମସ୍ତ ପ୍ରମାଣ ଅଛି। ଆପଣଙ୍କ କମ୍ପାନୀ
ବିରୁଦ୍ଧରେ ଅନେକ ମକଦ୍ଦମା ହେବା ଏମିତିକି ଅନ୍ତର୍ଜାତୀୟ ସ୍ତରରେ
ବି।

The Lead Developer's shoulders pull back, a muscle twitching visibly in his cheek. Several microphones are thrust closer to his face, invading his personal space. He glances desperately at his associates, who avoid his eyes, looking at their shoes. His shoulders slump. He takes a deep, ragged breath, the sound audible through the microphones.

LEAD DEVELOPER

ଠିକ୍ ଅଛି। ଶୁଣନ୍ତୁ... ଆମେ ଏ ପ୍ରକଳ୍ପରୁ ନିଜକୁ ସମ୍ପୂର୍ଣ୍ଣ ପ୍ରତ୍ୟାହାର
କରୁଛୁ।

A sudden, heavy SILENCE falls across the entire shoreline. The only sound is the gentle lapping of the waves against the sand. Then, a collective, stunned murmur rises from the villagers. Faces turn to each other, disbelief dawning into comprehension. A young woman near the front gasps audibly, her hand flying to her mouth. The Lead Developer clears his throat, his voice regaining a sliver of authority, though it cracks slightly.

LEAD DEVELOPER

ଆମର କୌଣସି ଦାବି ନାହିଁ। ଆପଣମାନେ ଏଠାରେ ସ୍ଥରକ୍ଷିତ।

ଏବଂ... ଏହା ତୁଡାନ୍ତ ନିଷ୍ପତ୍ତି।

He pushes past the reporters, almost running now, his associates scrambling to keep up, their suits flapping. As they disappear into the distance, a thunderous ROAR of triumph erupts from the villagers. CHEERS, shouts of joy, and heartfelt CRIES fill the air. People embrace tightly, tears streaming down their faces. Hands are thrown upwards in gratitude towards the sky. The media immediately pivots, their cameras swinging back to Ananya and the Legal Counsel, hungry for the next shot.

Ananya's eyes meet Dukhi's. Dukhi slowly turns his head towards Ananya, a profound calm in his blind eyes. He inclines his head once, a silent, weighty acknowledgment passing between them. Bina watches her daughter, her usual anxious expression replaced by a look of profound relief and quiet pride, a single tear tracing a path down her cheek.

ANANYA

ଏ ମାଟି ଆମରା ଆଉ ଆମେ ଏକାଠି ରହିବୁ।

The piercing, resonant BLAST of conch shells echoes across the shoreline, joining the joyful din of the crowd. The sea, in its vastness, seems to answer with a deeper, more triumphant roar, embracing the celebration.

CUT TO:

19. EXT. Revitalized Shoreline – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Children

The shoreline is pristine, the sand smoothed clean by the tide, shimmering under the sun. Small waves gently lap the shore. A group of CHILDREN chase small crabs at the water's edge. Their joyful laughter carries on the gentle breeze. Bare feet kick up sprays of water.

Ananya stands a little apart from the children, her figure framed against the expanse of the ocean. Her gaze follows their play, then drifts across the tranquil sea. A gentle smile spreads across her lips.

She takes a deep, slow breath, her chest rising and falling evenly. She closes her eyes for a moment, her face tilting towards the sun. Her shoulders visibly relax.

Ananya lowers her hand and gently touches the wet sand with her fingertips, tracing a shallow line before lifting them again. Her eyes remain on the horizon.

Ananya

ଏଇଟା ମୋର 'କୁଣାର ଗୀତ'... ମୋର ଘରା ମୋର ସବୁକିଛି।

20. EXT. Dukhi's Hut Porch – DAY

Characters: Dukhi, Bina, Ananya

The porch of Dukhi's hut is bathed in soft afternoon light. Dukhi sits on his usual wooden stool, facing the sea. Ananya stands a few steps away, looking out at the water. Bina approaches Dukhi, her steps slow. She stops behind him.

Bina

ବାପା... ମୁଁ ତୁମକୁ ବୁଝିପାରିନଥିଲି। କ୍ଷମା କରିଦିଅ ମୋତେ।

Bina's shoulders slump slightly. She takes a breath.

Bina

ସମୁଦ୍ର ତରରେ ମୁଁ ଭୁଲିଯାଇଥିଲି ଏ ଗୀତର ସ୍ମରଣ ଏବେ ମୁଁ
ଫେରିଛି।

Bina reaches out, gently placing a hand on Dukhi's shoulder. Dukhi's head turns slowly in her direction, his sightless eyes unfocused. Bina then steps forward and wraps her arms around him, resting her head on his shoulder. Dukhi's gnarled hands rise, slowly patting her back.

Dukhi

ମୁଁ ଜାଣିଥିଲି, ଦିନେ ତୁ ଫେରିଆସିବୁ, ମୋ ଝିଆ 'ଲୁଣାର ଗୀତ'
ତୋ ରକ୍ତରେ ଅଛି।

Bina

ମୁଁ ଏହାକୁ ରକ୍ଷା କରିବି, ବାପା। ଆମେ ସବୁ ମିଶି ରକ୍ଷା କରିବା।

Bina holds him tighter. Ananya watches them, a quiet smile on her lips, as her mother and grandfather hold each other.

21. EXT. Village Festival – DAY

Characters: Ananya, Dukhi, Bina, YOUNG MAN, YOUNG WOMAN, VILLAGERS

Bright orange and blue fabric banners billow between palm trees in the village square. Children dart through the festive crowd, their shouts rising above the rhythmic DHOL. Women ladle steaming pitha onto banana leaves, the sweet scent of jaggery mingling with the sea air.

Ananya stands near a newly erected wooden signboard, its fresh paint still gleaming. She gestures towards it, her voice calm and clear, as she addresses a small group of younger villagers gathered around her. She points out carved symbols and new text etched into the wood.

Under the banyan tree's shade, Dukhi leans back on a woven mat, his lips curved in a subtle, pleased smile. Bina settles next to him, her fingers lightly touching his forearm. Her gaze tracks Ananya, a soft pride softening her features.

A YOUNG MAN, younger than Ananya, steps forward from the group.

YOUNG MAN

ଆପା, ଆମେ ସବୁ ଆମ ଗାଁ ପାଇଁ ବଡ଼ ବଡ଼ ସ୍ୱପ୍ନ ଦେଖୁଛୁ। ଆମର
ନୂଆ ଯୋଜନା କ'ଣ?

ANANYA

ଦେଖ, ଏ ନୂଆ ବୋର୍ଡ଼ରେ ଆମ 'ସାଗର ସାଥୀ' ପ୍ରକଳ୍ପର ପ୍ରଥମ
ପାହାଚ ଅଛି। ଆସନ୍ତା ସପ୍ତାହରୁ ଆମେ ଉପକୂଳରେ ସମୁଦ୍ରକୂଳ
ଜଙ୍ଗଲ ଲଗାଇବା କାମ ଆରମ୍ଭ କରିବା। ଏହା ଆମ ମାଛ ଧରା
ଅଞ୍ଚଳକୁ ସୁରକ୍ଷା ଦେବ, ଆଉ ଆମ 'ଲୁଣାର ଗୀତ'କୁ ବଞ୍ଚାଇ ରଖିବ।

A young woman, Ananya's contemporary, steps forward, her posture eager.

YOUNG WOMAN

ଆମେ ସମସ୍ତେ ଆପଣଙ୍କ ସହିତ ଅଛୁ ଅପା। ମୁଁ ମୋ ପିଲାମାନଙ୍କୁ
ସାଥରେ ନେଇ ଆସିବି!

Ananya's smile warms her expression. She rotates towards the signboard, her palm brushing the carved symbols. Her eyes fix on the distant ocean, holding a silent promise.